



in early spring. Net against birds. Prune bushes hard in summer and winter—aim to create an open, well-ventilated structure.

HARVESTING AND STORING

Staggering your harvest by picking alternate berries will allow those left on the bush to grow larger and juicier; begin in late spring and continue throughout the summer. Early dual-purpose berries should be used for cooking; later ones for eating fresh. Dessert varieties are sweetest just after harvesting. Gooseberries will store for two weeks in the refrigerator or they can be frozen for later use.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Gooseberries are vulnerable to a number of pests and diseases, particularly gooseberry sawfly and gooseberry mildew; remove affected fruits or foliage and spray with insecticide. Use netting to deter birds.



Gooseberry sawfly larvae eat leaves.